Lagoon lakes are formed by wave deposition. Chilika Lake is the largest lagoon lake in India. Lonar Lake in Maharashtra is believed to be formed by depression created by meteor impact which hit during Pleistocene Epoch.

DO YOU KNOW?

Lake Toba on the island of Sumatra is the largest resurgent caldera on Earth.

Sambhar Lake in Rajasthan is the largest salt water lake in India.

Finland is known as land of thousand lakes.

Wetlands: Wetlands are areas of marsh, fen, peat land or water that is static or flowing, fresh, brackish or salt, including areas of marine water the depth of which at low tide does not exceed six metres.

Marshes are shallow wetlands around lakes, streams, or the ocean where grasses and reeds are common, without trees. **Rann of Kutch** in India is a salt marsh.

A **swamp** is a wetland with lush trees and vines found in a low-lying area beside slow-moving rivers. **Pallikaranai** wetland is a fresh water swamp adjacent to the Bay of Bengal situated in the southern part of Chennai.

Groundwater

Groundwater is the most valuable resource for any country. The rain water that falls on the earth either runs off as surface water or percolates into the ground to recharge the groundwater. The permeable rocks that can hold water and allow water to pass through them are called **aquifers.** The upper part of the saturated zone of the aquifer is called the **water table**. The level of water table fluctuates according to seasons (Figure 5.1).

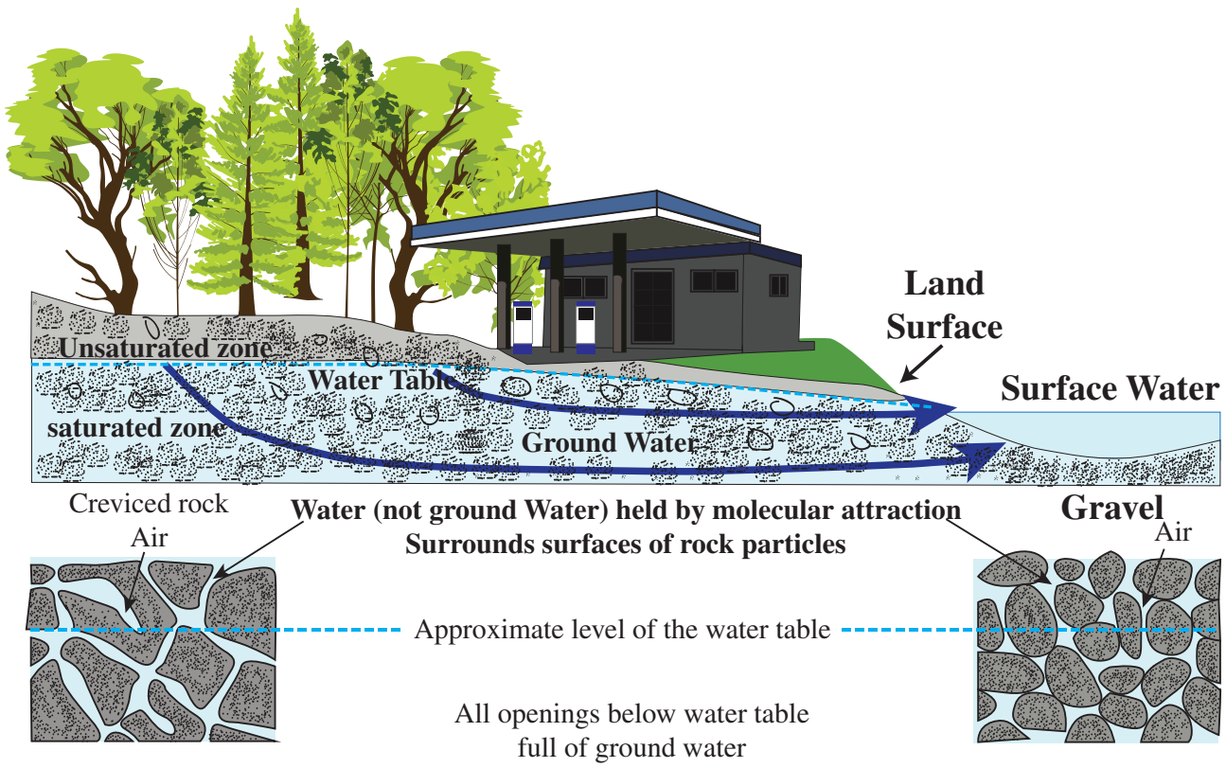


Figure 5.1 Ground water

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